

Shailja Lavania

PUBLIC POLICY & POLITICAL RESEARCHER

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Author, Kiul Nadi (Book in Progress)

Independent | Mar 2026 - Present | Giridih / New Delhi

- Writing narrative non-fiction on the ecological, cultural and socioeconomic dimensions of the Kiul River system in Jharkhand, spanning roughly 19 lakh residents across three districts.
- Field research in Giridih's Tisri block: mapping drainage networks, documenting tribal cultural practices, and tracking changes in water flow linked to deforestation and sand mining.
- Bringing together oral histories, government records and community conservation case studies.

Documentation Consultant

Savera Foundation | Jan - Mar 2026 | Giridih / New Delhi

- Wrote a seven-year (2018-2025) bilingual impact report for an NGO working across ten villages, combining survey data with community narratives.
- Analysed a baseline survey of 529 households (approximately 2,706 residents); documented a 160% rise in cropping intensity and 60% adoption of organic farming over the project period.
- Turned beneficiary data and technical findings into a public-facing document for donors and partners.

Legislative Associate to Members of Parliament

Bharat Rashtra Samithi | Aug 2024 - Feb 2026 | New Delhi

- Researched energy, infrastructure, PNG, coal and mines, and public grievances; produced reports and briefing material for Parliamentary Standing Committee meetings.
- Drafted 30+ parliamentary questions (eight balloted in the starred category), Zero Hour Mentions, Special Mentions and debate speeches.
- Liaised with ministries, railway officials and constituency stakeholders on advocacy and policy communications.

Legislative Advisor & Consultant - Data Intelligence

AICC | Feb 2024 - Feb 2026 | New Delhi

- Led research teams of 15 across five units, delivering policy datasets with a 95% on-time accuracy rate for campaign and outreach strategy.
- Designed stakeholder engagement frameworks and training protocols; trained and managed 60 interns across six states in political research and constituency-level data analysis.

Core Team Member - Shakti Abhiyan

All India Congress Committee (INC) | Jun - Oct 2025 | New Delhi

- Coordinated state, zonal and district teams across eight states for the women's political leadership programme, from induction through review.
- Created social media content and ran fortnightly coordination and capacity-building sessions.
- Led strategic planning and induction of new leaders; recognised for this work and offered the role of National Office Bearer.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE / CONTINUED

Public Policy Research Intern

CRFHGR | Feb - Mar 2024 | Remote

- Researched the National Judicial Appointments Commission and compared judicial systems across 10+ countries; wrote public-facing articles.

Operations & Strategy Analyst

Shopdeck (Blitzscale Technologies) | Dec 2022 - Oct 2023 | Bengaluru / Hybrid

- Improved e-commerce quality standards by 30% through a 100-point compliance framework, cutting customer complaints by 20%; represented the company in client meetings as client retention rose 30%.

Data Research Analyst

S&P Global Market Intelligence | May 2019 - May 2021 | Ahmedabad

- Built executive compensation and capital-markets datasets for globally listed US and Canadian firms; mentored analysts and improved team workflows.
- Received the Rockstar Rookie Award for Excellence in Data Research.

PUBLICATION

The Right to Breastfeed Means Little Without a Place For Mothers to Do It

The Quint | Opinion | 21 June 2026

EDUCATION

MA, Political Science

Indira Gandhi National Open University, New Delhi | 2021-2022

MBA, Finance & Marketing

Banasthali Vidyapith, Jaipur | 2017-2019

Selected as one of four from 400 students for the MoHRD Faculty Development Programme.

Bachelor of Commerce

Dr. B.R. Ambedkar University, Agra | 2014-2017

RESEARCH, LANGUAGES & TOOLS

Research & writing: Policy analysis, legislative research, literature reviews, issue briefs and discussion papers, opinion writing, narrative non-fiction, bilingual writing (Hindi and English).

Data & tools: Advanced MS Excel (pivot tables, VLOOKUP, VBA), Python, R, VS Code, Canva (Advanced), Google Workspace, Notebook LM.

Languages: Hindi (native), English (fluent), Braj (fluent).

CERTIFICATIONS & RECOGNITION

- Rockstar Rookie Award for Excellence in Data Research, S&P Global.
- Computer Statistical Techniques & Application Certification, Banasthali Vidyapith.
- Volunteer: Miyawaki technique tree plantation and financial literacy mentorship, S&P Global.